Howbridge Infant School

Computing Policy

Date last reviewed by Governing Body: Summer 2026

The Howbridge Infant School

POLICY NAME: Computing **DATE OF REVIEW: May 2027**

Aims and priorities for subject teaching and learning

The core of computing is computer science, in which pupils are taught the principles of information and computation, how digital systems work, and how to put this knowledge to use through programming.

The National Curriculum for computing aims to ensure that all pupils in KS1:

- understand what algorithms are; how they are implemented as programs on digital devices; and that programs execute by following precise and unambiguous instructions
- create and debug simple programs
- use logical reasoning to predict the behaviour of simple programs
- use technology purposefully to create, organise, store, manipulate and retrieve digital content
- recognise common uses of information technology beyond school
- use technology safely and respectfully, keeping personal information private; identify where to go for help and support when they have concerns about content or contact on the internet or other online technologies

e-Safety (see separate e-Safety Policy in conjunction with this policy)

We recognise it is fundamentally important to ensure pupils are safe when using ICT and have systems in place for achieving this. We are committed to teaching pupils a systematic approach to e-Safety when using the internet, email and learning platforms.

- The school has an accredited CEOP trained e-Safety officer.
- The school has an e-Safety and Data Security policy in place which all staff are familiar with.
- There is an e-Safety committee which includes members of staff and pupils (class representatives).
- Safer Internet Day is promoted and explored with the children and they participate in a range of related activities.
- Sanctions and reward systems are used. Incidents of misuse are monitored by the deputy head/headteacher and appropriate rewards are provided for positive use of the internet (SENSO).
- A range of mascots and resources are used to encourage the children to stay safe online.
- The intervention room and classroom displays promote safer internet use.
- There is a dedicated page on the school website for e-Safety.
- e-Safety newsletters are sent out to parents throughout the year.
- New safer search engine has been installed on the ChromeBooks which monitors what the children are searching for and filters results.

Health and Safety

The following guidelines are in place to promote high standards in health and safety which are in line with current VDU legislation :

- Pupils are encouraged to sit in an appropriate position when using the computers.
- Pupils do not exceed the recommended guideline for a maximum time of 2 hours a day working at a computer

- Liquids must not be taken near laptops/devices.
- All hardware will undergo an annual PAT testing safety check to ensure the electrical safety of all equipment

Sources

The 2014 Primary National Curriculum England
EYFS Development Matters
Teach Computing - National Centre for Computing Education

Strategies for teaching

Digital medium, e.g. CleverTouch boards, iPads, ChromeBooks, Beebots, EYFS digital tables etc. are available for use in the classroom and school environment.

Planning, marking and feedback

School policy is followed as set out in separate documents.
In KS1, medium term and weekly plans for skills based lessons are taken and adapted if needed from the Teach Computing website and this is based on the National Curriculum. Feedback is given to the children verbally during lessons and any development points are actioned by the child during that session.
In Reception, skill based lessons are interleaved into all areas of the children's learning. Children are introduced to the skills that they will later develop in KS1.

Assessment, recording and reporting

Assessments are made regularly, recorded and reported to parents following school and National guidelines.
Evidence of children's ICT work is kept in class floor books, via photographs, in topic folders or displayed on the walls.
Assessment is completed at the end of each term for each class against National Curriculum outcomes.
In Reception children's attainment is recorded in their Tapestry Learning Journey and class floor books.

Inclusion - equal opportunities, racial awareness, gender, SEN

We aim to set suitable learning targets, respond to pupil's diverse needs and overcome potential barriers to learning and assessment for groups and individuals and follow the guidance as set out in page 8 of The 2014 Primary National Curriculum, Key Stage 1 and 2.
We are committed to providing a teaching environment conducive to learning. Each child is valued, respected and challenged regardless of ability, race, gender, religion, social background, culture and disability.

Teachers will always be flexible when teaching computing in order to support children's well-being, mental health, behaviour and sensory needs, making teaching and learning therapeutic e.g. taking learning outside where possible, allowing learners to work on the floor with iPads.
We utilise computing software to specifically help pupils meet and extend curriculum learning objectives for all subjects. Software is available to support both lower achievers working towards their expected levels and also those pupils working above their expected levels. We also obtain additional hardware to enable pupils with specific physical, behavioural and academic needs to assess the same skills.

e-Safety threads link to a range of school policies, in particular, e-Safety and Data Security, Child Protection, Safeguarding, Anti-Bullying, Behaviour and PSHE.

Resource use, monitoring and acquisition

The school manual for budget holders sets out the financial regulations and procedures for the acquisition of resources.

- 32 Chromebooks
- 60 iPads
- Beebots (12 per class)
- All classrooms have a CleverTouch board
- Interactive/touch screen board in school hall
- All teachers and TAs have a laptop for school use

Software is kept on a central server and can be accessed around the school.

Sustainability is always a focus throughout our setting and any equipment used and no longer needed/broken will be recycled. We are careful not to order more than what we need and encourage children to only charge equipment when necessary.

Staff feedback to subject leaders any requirements for new resources for their curriculum area.

Links with other subjects including SMSC

As well as developing computing skills, where appropriate, computing should be incorporated into plans for all subjects and used to support learning across the curriculum.

Monitoring and evaluation of teaching and learning

Procedures for monitoring teaching and learning are set out in subject management, assessment and other support policies.

The computing policy is reviewed annually by staff and governors.

Monitoring of standards of pupil's work is achieved through work sampling, monitoring planning and lessons, discussion with staff and pupils and looking at computing displays.

Staff and school development

Staff and school development needs are identified through School Evaluation and Development Planning and Performance Management procedures.

Howbridge Infant School is supported by ICT Solutions and training can also be arranged through LGfL.

Review

This policy will be reviewed annually as part of the subject development programme. It will be re-drafted periodically as necessary taking account of the school's development plan and new local and National Curriculum requirements.

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